New York State Regents Examination in English Language Arts
Part 2
Writing From Sources: Argument

Criteria	6 Essays exhibit	5 Essays exhibit	4 Essays exhibit	3 Essays exhibit	2 Essays exhibit	1 Essays exhibit
Content and Analysis: the extent to which the essay conveys complex ideas by: • introducing a claim • analyzing the sources and topic • distinguishing the claim from alternate or opposing claims	• sophisticated claim • insightful source and topic analysis • insightful evaluation of a counterclaim	• thorough claim • thorough source and topic analysis • thorough evaluation of a counterclaim	• specific claim • appropriate source and topic analysis • appropriate evaluation of a counterclaim	• surface-level claim • emerging source and topic analysis • insufficient evaluation of a counterclaim	• limited claim • unclear or confused source and topic analysis • confused or no counterclaim	• unrelated or no claim • no source and/or topic analysis
Command of Evidence: the extent to which the essay supports analysis by: • incorporating relevant evidence from sources • avoiding plagiarism when citing the texts	• sophisticated support using a wide range of strategically chosen, relevant evidence • consistent avoidance of plagiarism with acceptable citation format(s)	• thorough and accurate support using effective and relevant evidence • consistent avoidance of plagiarism with acceptable citation format(s)	• sufficient and adequate support using relevant evidence • consistent avoidance of plagiarism with acceptable citation format(s)	• basic support using relevant and/or generalized evidence • partial avoidance of plagiarism with emerging citation format(s)	• insufficient support using limited, inaccurate, or irrelevant evidence • insufficient avoidance of plagiarism	• provides no evidence • no use of citations
Coherence, Organization, and Style: the extent to which the essay addresses the claim as a cohesive, unified whole by: • maintaining focus on task • organizing ideas • optimizing language style	• strategic focus on task • strategic organization of ideas • sophisticated language and sentence structure	• clear and appropriate focus on task • thoughtful organization of ideas • precise language and sentence structure	• acceptable focus on task • logical organization of ideas • appropriate language and sentence structure	• emerging focus on task • emerging organization of ideas • basic language and sentence structure	• lack appropriate focus on task, but suggest organization of ideas **-or-** • suggest a focus on task, but lack organization of ideas • imprecise language	• little to no focus on task • little to no organization of ideas • incoherent language **-or-** • minimal writing, making assessment unreliable
Control of Conventions: the extent to which the essay establishes a framework for clear communication by: • displaying control of 9–12 band grammar, usage, capitalization, punctuation, and spelling • maintaining control relative to language characteristics	• exceptional control • virtually no errors when using sophisticated language	• considerable control • errors that do not hinder comprehension, even when using sophisticated language	• partial control • errors that do not hinder comprehension	• emerging control • errors that hinder comprehension	• lack of control • errors that make comprehension difficult	• significant lack of control • errors that severely interfere with comprehension **-or-** • minimal writing, making assessment unreliable

- An essay that uses information from fewer than 3 sources can be scored no higher than a 3.
- An essay that is entirely unrelated to the topic and/or makes no reference to the sources or task can be scored no higher than a 1.
- An essay that is predominantly a verbatim copy from the task or sources with negligible student writing must be scored a 0.
- An essay that is indecipherable, entirely incoherent, unrecognizable as English, or blank must be scored a 0.